

Top Insights on AI for CHROs

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Initiatives: Transform HR through AI; Technologies and Markets; Strategy, Risks and Opportunities

CHROs have two key priorities related to AI transformation, including the integration of agentic AI and generative AI: shaping work in the human-machine era and harnessing AI to revolutionize HR. Use these key resources to embark on a successful AI transformation journey.

Gartner's Take

As the executive responsible for all people matters, the CHRO is under increasing pressure to prepare the workforce for AI and redesign work around effective human-AI partnerships. They must do so while balancing a human-machine approach to AI transformation.

Gartner research indicates that prioritizing technology over employee adoption leads to limited returns on AI investments. At the same time, CHROs must set the strategy to transform their own function with AI, rethinking service delivery and business value creation in alignment with organizational objectives. If CHROs do not lead on AI strategy and implementation now, they risk exposing their organizations to significant operating risks: a workforce unprepared to support growth from AI investments and an HR function unable to deliver expected business value.

Analysis

Shape Work in the Human-Machine Era

How AI is Reshaping Work

AI and agentic AI will transform how work gets done across the enterprise, but not in the same way for every role or for every organization. Contrary to the dominant narrative that AI will completely eliminate roles, as of December 2025, only one in four CHROs report that their enterprise has replaced employees with AI or automation in the past 12 months. ¹ A larger portion of CHROs report that their enterprise has redeployed employees (37%), redesigned team structures (48%) and redefined job roles (40%) due to AI or emerging technologies. ¹ This clearly demonstrates how AI is (re)shaping work in the human-machine era.

Through both business and operating model transformation, AI is fundamentally altering where and how organizations create value. As a result, AI will either augment or reengineer existing work, or invent completely new work.

However, CHROs suffer from the perception of limited AI readiness. **As of December 2025, only 10% of C-level executives and senior leaders believe that CHROs have strong AI-savviness relative to what their organizations need in 2026 or 2027.** ² Unless CHROs play an active role in managing AI's impact on all employees, they risk negative business outcomes and diminishing HR's role within the organization.

Many HR functions have worked to drive AI literacy and the upskilling of the workforce, but these efforts alone can't match the pace or scale of change that AI adoption brings. **Organizations can only achieve better business outcomes through AI by having a proactive and structured approach to AI's impact on the workforce and how work gets done.**

Harness AI to Revolutionize HR

Building an AI-Ready HR Function

Addressing AI's impact on the workforce represents only part of the strategic challenge facing CHROs. They must also build an AI-ready HR function. As of December 2025, 95% of CHROs report having AI initiatives in their organization. ¹ Over the next 12 months, CHROs expect 54% of the AI-related changes to their function to be focused on HR workflow augmentation. ¹ Workflow reengineering or the invention of completely new HR services as a result of AI will constitute 31% and 14%, respectively. ¹

While many HR functions continue to rapidly adopt AI use cases, the value they have realized from AI remains modest. **As of December 2025, one-third of CHROs report no to minimal value from AI investments within their organization. The majority (49%) report moderate value, while only 18% report significant to transformational value.** ¹

Most HR teams are implementing isolated solutions rather than coordinated, long-term strategies. This explains why transformational value has been minimal for most HR functions. CHROs should move beyond tactical deployments and define a comprehensive AI strategy for HR that aligns technology investments with business priorities, cost management and workforce needs. **CHROs should assess the impact of AI on HR roles, structure and service delivery to ensure that the function is prepared to support enterprise AI objectives. This approach fosters sustainable value creation beyond short-term productivity gains.**

This research collection provides resources to help CHROs and their teams get up to speed more quickly and mature their approach by answering key journey step questions across their two main priorities:

Priority 1: Shape Work in the Human-Machine Era

- Step 1: Position HR as a critical partner in the organization's AI strategy.
- Step 2: Evaluate AI's impact on work and lead design efforts to achieve your evolving AI-human work ambition.
- Step 3: Define, measure and manage an evolving workforce to be ready for AI's continual evolution.

- Step 4: Lead enterprisewide workforce planning to understand human capability needs, forecast workforce costs and leverage new employment models.
- Step 5: Evolve talent initiatives to meet enterprise needs.

Priority 2: Harness AI to Revolutionize HR

- Step 1: Create and deploy an HR strategy that supports AI transformation and enterprise goals.
- Step 2: Redesign the HR operating model and HR roles for the AI era.
- Step 3: Identify high-value AI and technology use cases across HR.
- Step 4: Evaluate the AI vendor landscape and technology use cases across HR.
- Step 5: Build a governance framework to measure and evolve your AI in HR strategy.

Research Highlights

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Priority 1: Shape Work in the Human-Machine Era

Gartner's Position: The most mature CHROs step up as enterprise leaders. They actively shape work in the human-machine era to secure business success. AI will change the way organizations do work, leading to shifts in required roles, skill sets, workforce planning and work volumes. A deeper human-AI partnership will increase the augmentation of work and require a human-centric approach to workforce strategy.

Sixty-two percent of CEOs believe that AI will define the next business era. ³ This once-in-a-generation shift will transform how work gets done and how businesses operate. However, only 21% of CIOs report that their enterprise prioritizes mitigating the negative impacts of AI on employees' work, ⁴ leaving critical gaps in both skills training and the development of a human-centric approach to AI.

These gaps give CHROs a central role in the coming transformation, both in evolving HR service delivery and preparing the broader workforce for an AI-enabled future. Unless CHROs play an active role in managing AI's impact on employees and work, they risk diminishing HR's influence within the organization. Likewise, they risk being held accountable when the organization's AI investments fail to deliver the expected returns.

Recommended Journey Steps and Supporting Resources

Step 1: Position HR as a critical partner in the organization's AI strategy

- [How CHROs Can Build Digital Influence for Effective AI Leadership \(Added 13 January 2026\)](#)
- [Tool: Communication Guide for CHRO & CIO Partnerships \(Added 13 January 2026\)](#)
- [Transforming How Work Gets Done: 2025 HR Symposium/Xpo Keynote Highlights](#)
- [The Top 5 Questions for CHROs to Ask About AI's Impact on the Workforce](#)

Step 2: Evaluate AI's impact on work and lead design efforts to achieve your evolving AI-human work ambition

- [Beyond Augmentation: How to Adapt Work to Achieve AI Impact \(Added 13 January 2026\)](#)
- [How AI Will Change Your Organization Design \(Added 13 January 2026\)](#)
- [3 Tactics to Prevent GenAI-Driven Skills Loss by Focusing on Early Career Talent \(Added 13 January 2026\)](#)
- [AI-Enabled Performance Demands HR Redesign Work: Insights From a Talent Leader \(Added 13 January 2026\)](#)

Step 3: Define, measure and manage an evolving workforce to prepare for AI's continual evolution

- [The Rise of the AI Toolmate: Defining AI's Role in the Workforce \(Added 13 January 2026\)](#)
- [How CHROs Can Unlock AI Success for the Enterprise by Overcoming AI Adoption Barriers](#)

- [Path to AI Adoption and ROI: CHRO Strategies to Accelerate AI Literacy Programs](#)

Step 4: Lead enterprisewide workforce planning to understand human capability needs, forecast workforce costs and leverage new employment models

- [AI's Impact on Jobs: Frequently Asked Questions and Gartner's Answers](#) (Added 13 January 2026)
- [Develop an AI Layoff Strategy to Manage CEO Expectations and Mitigate Talent Risks](#) (Added 13 January 2026)
- [Toolkit: How to Evaluate the Impact of AI on Talent and Establish Appropriate Workforce Plans](#) (Added 13 January 2026)
- [Adapting Workforce Strategies to Prepare for AI's Impact on Jobs](#)
- [AI's Ripple Effect on Jobs and Organizations](#)

Step 5: Evolve talent initiatives to meet enterprise needs

- [Evolve Early Career Development for the AI Era](#) (Added 13 January 2026)
- [Guide Managers to Effectively Integrate AI Into Employees' Work](#) (Added 13 January 2026)
- [Four Key Elements of a Talent Strategy That Drive Performance Today and Tomorrow](#) (Added 13 January 2026)

CHROs and their teams can refer to the [AI Use Case and Best Practice Library](#) for regularly updated best-practice AI examples from other organizations.

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Priority 2: Harness AI to Revolutionize HR



Gartner's Position: Organizations need a coordinated, strategy-based approach to AI in HR to realize the full value of AI investments. HR investments in AI are a top priority, and affect HR services across the employee life cycle — including operations, service delivery, recruiting, learning and development, and talent management. But most HR functions have seen only marginal gains due to piecemeal and siloed implementation.

Meanwhile, advancements in agentic AI are poised to change the way work gets done. In many parts of the enterprise, including HR, employees will move from executing workflows and delivering services themselves to building and maintaining agentic AI solutions that perform these tasks. This overhaul will redefine HR roles, require new skills and change how HR delivers services.

Building a comprehensive HR-focused AI strategy, aligned with your enterprisewide AI strategy, and appointing an AI product lead in HR will enable more meaningful outcomes.

Recommended Journey Steps and Supporting Resources

Step 1: Create and deploy an HR strategy that supports AI transformation and enterprise goals

- [AI Can't Be an Afterthought in HR Strategy \(Added 13 January 2026\)](#)
- [How CHROs Can Maximize Value From AI: Strategy, Operating Model and Investment Priorities \(Added 13 January 2026\)](#)
- [Create an AI Strategy for Your HR Organization \(Added 13 January 2026\)](#)
- [Agentic AI Benchmarks Across the Enterprise and HR](#)

Step 2: Redesign the HR operating model and HR roles for the AI era

- [HR in 2030: Plan Now for HR's Future Roles \(Added 13 January 2026\)](#)
- [Redesign the HRBP Role as AI Transformation Consultants \(Added 13 January 2026\)](#)
- [Reconfigure L&D to Effectively Support Agentic AI \(Added 13 January 2026\)](#)
- [The Impact of AI on the HR Operating Model](#)

- [Choose the Best HR Operating Model for an AI-Enabled Enterprise](#)

Step 3: Identify high-value AI and technology use cases across HR

- [Hype Cycle for AI in Human Resources, 2025](#)
- [Tool: AI in HR Workshop: Ideation and Prioritization](#)
- [Infographic: AI's Impact Across HR Processes \(Added 13 January 2026\)](#)
- [Quick Answer: AI Agent Essentials for CHROs](#)
- [Prepare for the Future of AI Agents in HR \(Added 13 January 2026\)](#)
- [AI Use-Case Assessment for HR](#)
- [AI Use-Case Assessment for Talent Management](#)
- [AI Use-Case Assessment for Talent Acquisition \(Recruiting\)](#)
- [AI Use-Case Assessment for Learning and Development](#)
- [AI in Total Rewards: Key Risks & Emerging Use Cases \(Added 13 January 2026\)](#)
- [Tool: AI-Opportunity-Driven Performance Management Innovation Assessment](#)
- [Reimagine HR Self-Service With AI Technologies \(Added 13 January 2026\)](#)
- [Innovation Insight: AI in Recruiting Technology \(Added 13 January 2026\)](#)

Step 4: Evaluate the AI vendor landscape and technology use cases across HR

- [7 Factors to Assess HR AI Agent Capabilities](#)
- [Framework for Evaluating AI Capabilities in HCM Suites](#)
- [AI in HCM Suites: Evolution, Use Cases and Pricing \(Added 13 January 2026\)](#)
- [Cool Vendors in AI for HR Technology \(Added 13 January 2026\)](#)
- [Tool: Choose the Best AI Recruiting Tech Vendor for Your Organization \(Added 13 January 2026\)](#)

Step 5: Build a governance framework to measure and evolve your AI in HR strategy

- [Address 5 Gaps to Unlock HR AI Agent Success](#) (Added 13 January 2026)
- [3 Steps to Establish AI-Ready HR Data](#)
- [Tool: AI Data Readiness Scorecard for HR](#) (Added 13 January 2026)
- [Reference Guide for AI Governance](#) (Added 13 January 2026)

CHROs and their teams can refer to the [AI Use Case and Best Practice Library](#) for regularly updated AI in HR use-case examples from their peers.

Evidence

¹ **The 2025 Gartner Q4 AI and HR Function CHRO Survey.** This survey was conducted to gain insights into CHRO perspectives on the current state of AI within their organizations and HR functions, as well as to collect up-to-date information on HR functional transformation. The research was conducted online from 17 November to 16 December 2025 and contains responses from 110 heads of HR with representation from various geographies, industries and functions. *Disclaimer: The results of this survey do not represent global findings or the market as a whole, but reflect the sentiments of the respondents and companies surveyed.*

² **2025 Gartner Executive Leadership Team Effectiveness Survey.** This survey was conducted to understand executive leadership team effectiveness, role expectations, C-suite transitions, AI readiness and enterprise AI strategy. The survey was conducted online from 31 October 2025 through 9 December 2025, and contains responses from 197 CxO roles (excluding CEOs), Executive Vice Presidents, Senior Vice Presidents, and Vice Presidents, with representation across various regions and industries. *Disclaimer: The results of this survey do not represent global findings or the market as a whole, but reflect the sentiments of the respondents and companies surveyed.*

³ **2025 Gartner CEO and Senior Business Executive Survey.** This survey was conducted to examine CEO and senior business executive views on current business issues, as well as some areas of technology agenda impact. The survey was conducted from June 2024 through November 2024, with questions about the period from 2024 through 2026. One-quarter of the survey sample was collected from June through July 2024, and three-quarters was collected from October through November 2024. In total, 456 actively employed CEOs and other senior executive business leaders qualified and participated. The research was collected via 421 online surveys and 35 telephone interviews. The sample mix by role was CEOs (n = 303); CFOs (n = 95); COOs or other C-level executives (n = 39); and chairs, presidents or board directors (n = 19). The sample mix by location was North America (n = 194), Europe (n = 118), Asia/Pacific (n = 91), Latin America (n = 35), the Middle East (n = 15) and South Africa (n = 2). The sample mix by size was \$50 million to less than \$250 million (n = 32), \$250 million to less than \$1 billion (n = 122), \$1 billion to less than \$10 billion (n = 200) and \$10 billion or more (n = 102). *Disclaimer: Results of this survey do not represent global findings or the market as a whole, but reflect the sentiments of the respondents and companies surveyed.*

⁴ **2024 Gartner AI Survey: CIO and Technology Leader View.** This survey was conducted to capture CIOs' and technology leaders' sentiment toward AI and to better understand what organizations are doing as a result of recent changes and announcements about AI. The survey was conducted online in June and July 2024 among CIOs (n = 314) and other technology leaders (n = 394). The total sample was 708 respondents, with representation from North America (n = 329), EMEA (n = 253), Asia/Pacific (n = 89) and Oceania (n = 37) and across all industry sectors. *Disclaimer: Results of this study do not represent global findings or the market as a whole but reflect sentiment of the respondents and companies surveyed.*

Evolving Insights History

Table 1: Evolving Insights History

Published Date ↓	Update ↓
13 January 2026	Major update to highlight key priorities, add data points from December 2025, and add new resources under each subsection.
29 October 2025	Minor update to add new resources to each subsection
01 August 2025	■ Amendment to title. ■ The addition of Gartner position statements. ■ The addition of key data points from latest client benchmarking polls. ■ The addition of new resources under each subsection.
06 June 2025	■ The addition of agentic AI as a subsection including key resources for CHROs. ■ The addition of two new resources under the subsection focused on AI's impact on the workforce.
06 May 2025	Initial Publish

Recommended by the Authors

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[Innovation Insight: AI in Recruiting Technology](#)

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